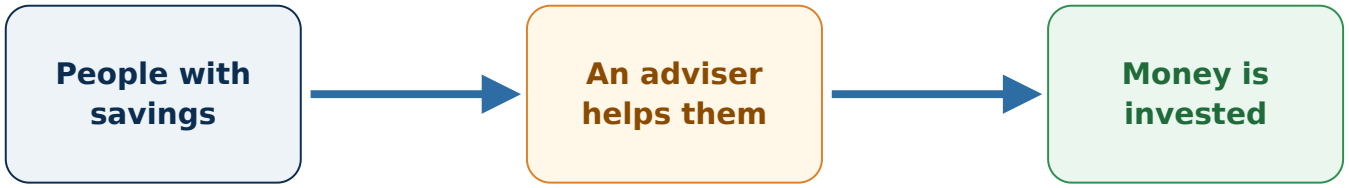
BEGINNER'S GUIDE

St. James's Place, explained from zero

What the firm does, how it makes money, and what your graduate job actually is



That is the whole business in one picture. The rest of this guide fills in the detail.

How to use this guide

- Read it **in order**. Each page explains one idea and builds on the page before.
- No prior knowledge assumed. Every new word is explained the first time it appears.
- Coloured boxes: **blue** = key idea, **orange** = tip for your interview, **red** = common mistake, **green** = something you can say.
- Numbers come from SJP's own published results unless marked "≈" (an estimate or rounded figure).

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1. The basic idea: why people pay for help with money
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16. What "wealth management" really means
17. Your job: where you'd sit
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Prepared 6 November 2026. Figures can change; check SJP's website before a live interview.

PAGE 1 · THE BASIC IDEA

Why do people pay someone to help with their money?

Imagine you're 58. You have £300,000 spread across three old work pensions, an ISA and some savings. You want to retire at 62. You have questions like these:



Most people don't have the time or knowledge to answer these themselves, and a mistake is expensive. So they pay a **financial adviser**, a qualified professional who looks at their whole situation and tells them what to do.

> **KEY IDEA**
> Advisers are usually paid a **small percentage of the money** they look after, every year. For example, 0.8% of £300,000 is £2,400 a year. So the more money a client has, the more the adviser earns. That one fact explains a lot of how SJP works.

Three ways people can manage their money

1. Do it yourself

Use an app or website to pick your own investments. Cheap, but you make all the decisions. *Example: AJ Bell, Hargreaves Lansdown.*

2. Get advice

A person plans your finances and recommends what to do. Costs more, but you get expertise and someone to call. *Example: **SJP**.*

3. Hand it over completely

A manager makes all the investment decisions for you. Usually for wealthier people. *Example: Rathbones.*

SJP is firmly in option 2. Its whole business is built around advisers giving advice.

PAGE 2 · VOCABULARY

The ten words you need

Learn these ten and you'll understand 90% of any conversation about SJP.

1. Wealth management

Helping individuals plan and look after their money over their whole life.

2. Financial adviser

A qualified person who recommends what to do with your money. At SJP they're called **Partners**.

3. FUM (Funds Under Management)

The total money a firm looks after for its clients. SJP's is about **£240 billion**.

4. Fund

A big pot where many people's money is pooled and invested in shares, bonds and so on by a professional manager.

5. Wrapper

The "box" your investments sit in, which decides the tax rules. Examples: **pension**, **ISA**, **investment bond**.

6. Pension

A wrapper for retirement savings. You get tax relief going in, but can't take the money out until your mid-50s.

7. ISA

A wrapper where up to £20,000 a year can be invested and grow tax-free.

8. Inflows / outflows

Gross inflows = new money coming in. **Net inflows** = new money in *minus* money taken out.

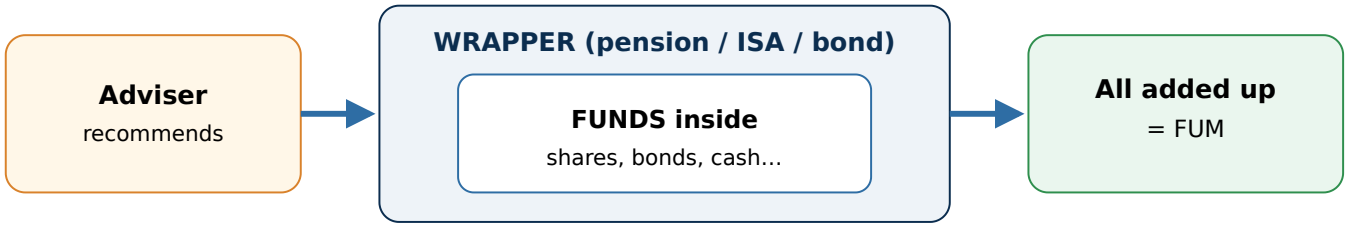
9. Retention

The share of money that stays with the firm each year. SJP keeps about **95%**.

10. FCA

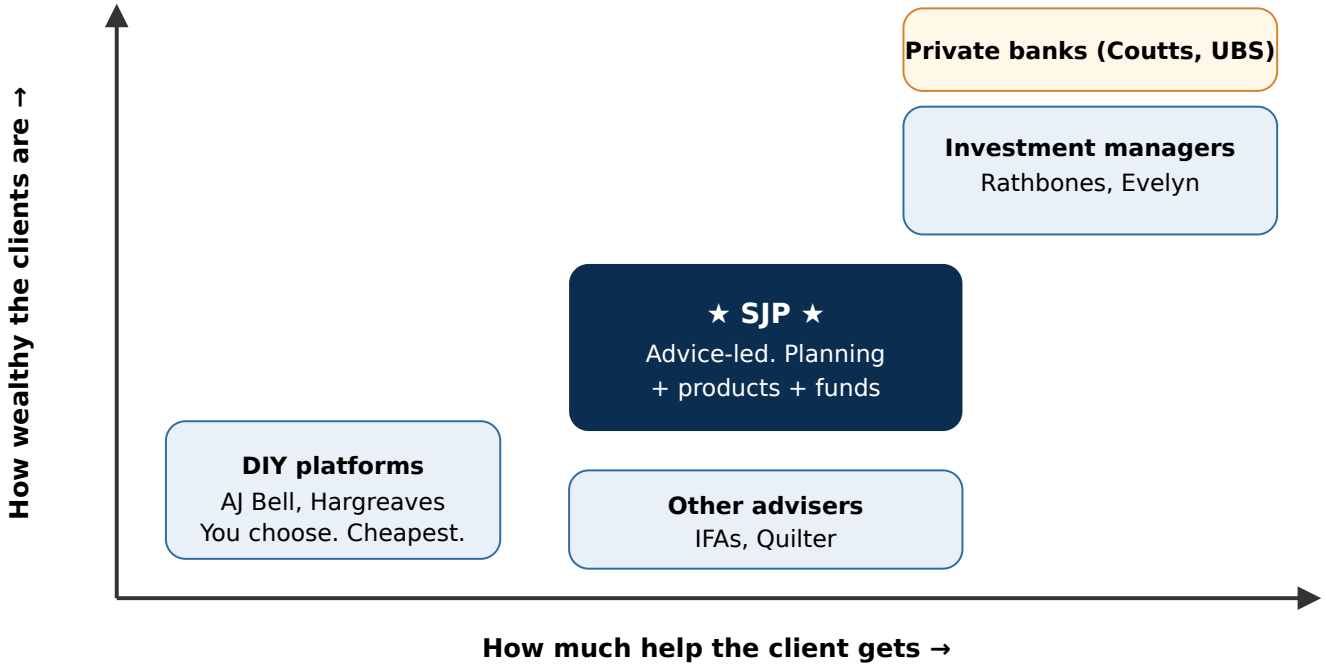
The Financial Conduct Authority, the UK regulator that sets the rules for how firms treat customers.

How the words fit together



The different kinds of "money firm"

"Wealth management" covers several different businesses. This map shows where SJP sits.



Type of firm	What it does	Example
Financial adviser	Plans your whole financial life and recommends what to do	**SJP**, Quilter, local IFAs
Investment manager	Runs your investment portfolio for you	Rathbones, Evelyn
DIY platform	An app or website where you invest yourself	AJ Bell, Hargreaves Lansdown
Private bank	Banking, loans and investing for the very rich (often £10m+)	Coutts, JP Morgan, UBS
Asset manager	*Makes* funds and sells them to millions of investors; doesn't advise individuals	BlackRock, Schroders

COMMON MISTAKE

SJP is **not** a private bank and does **not** mainly serve the super-rich. Its typical client is comfortably off (≈£226k invested with SJP on average), not a multi-millionaire.

PAGE 4 · THE FIRM

What is St. James's Place?

In one sentence: SJP is the UK's **biggest financial advice business**. It **also owns the products and funds** its advisers recommend, and makes money by taking a **small yearly percentage** of every pound it looks after.

£240bn money looked after (FUM), mid-2026	**1.06m** clients	**≈5,000** advisers ("Partners")
≈£226k average invested per client	**≈95%** of money stays each year	**£462m** profit in 2025

An easy way to picture it: a franchise

Think of a coffee chain where each café is run by its own owner, but uses the chain's name, coffee and systems. SJP works in a similar way:

Coffee chain (analogy)

- Café owner runs their own shop
- Uses the chain's brand and coffee
- Head office supplies systems and rules

→

St. James's Place

- Partner runs their own advice business
- Uses SJP's brand, products and funds
- Head office supplies tools and checks

The analogy isn't exact (SJP isn't legally a franchise), but it's a good way to picture the set-up.

Why SJP is unusual: it owns every layer

With most advisers, the client pays several different companies. At SJP, one company owns them all. This is called **vertical integration**.

Typical adviser: 4 different firms

- Advice: Adviser firm A
- Wrapper: Provider B
- Admin platform: Platform C
- Funds: Fund house D

SJP: one firm owns all 4

St. James's Place

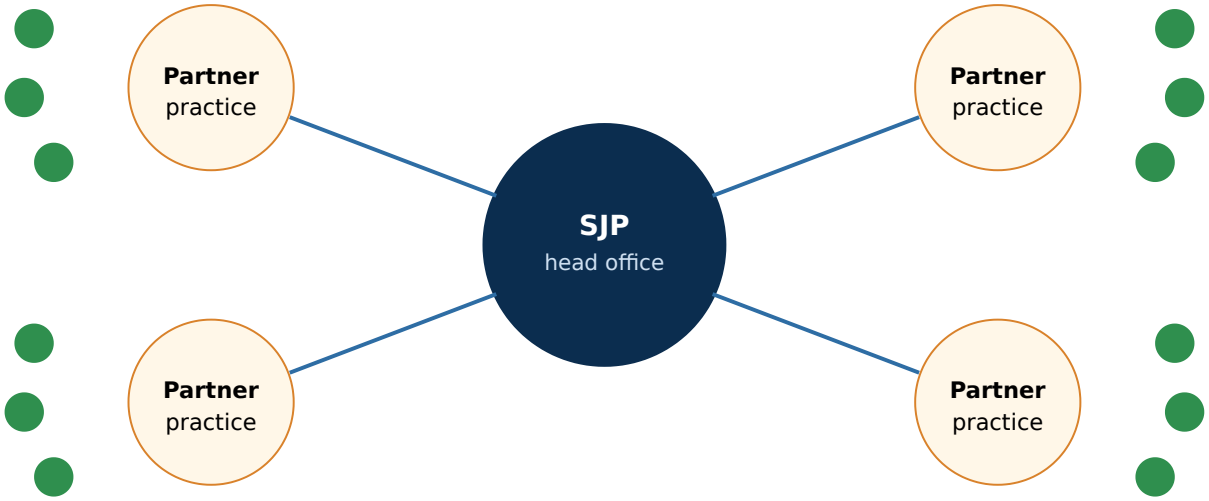
Advice ✓
Wrapper ✓
Admin (outsourced, SJP pays) ✓
Funds ✓

WHY THIS MATTERS

SJP earns a slice at **every** layer, and clients find it harder to leave. The downside: SJP advisers mainly recommend SJP's own products. This is called **"restricted" advice**, as opposed to "independent" advice, which can recommend anything on the market.

The Partnership: SJP's advisers

SJP's advisers mostly **don't work for SJP as employees**. They're self-employed business owners called **Partners**. Together they're known as "the Partnership".



Green dots = clients. ≈5,000 advisers, each looking after ≈215 clients and ≈£49m on average.

What the Partner does

Finds clients (mostly through referrals), gives the advice, and owns the relationship. Earns the advice fees. Can grow their business and eventually sell it.

What SJP head office does

Provides the brand, products, funds, technology and training. Checks the advice is good, because **SJP is legally responsible** for its Partners' advice in the regulator's eyes.

Where new advisers come from: the SJP Academy

SJP runs its own **Academy** that trains people, often career-changers, to become advisers. More than 89% of people who finish it are still at SJP three years later.

INTERVIEW TIP

Your graduate role is **not** in the Academy and you won't be a Partner. You'd be in head office, helping the Partners. Section 17 explains this.

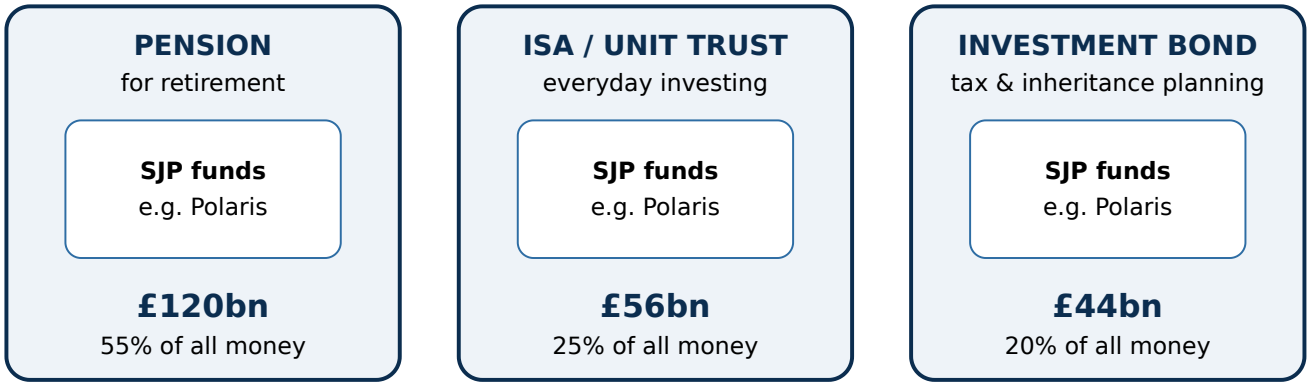
WHY THE MODEL WORKS, AND ITS WEAK SPOT

Partners are entrepreneurs, so they work hard to win and keep clients, and the business grows. But SJP is responsible for thousands of advisers it doesn't directly manage. That's where problems have come from (see page 14).

PAGE 6 · PRODUCTS

What SJP sells: boxes, and what goes inside them

Every pound a client invests goes into a **box** (the wrapper, which sets the tax rules). Inside the box is a **fund** (where the money is actually invested). SJP owns both.



Figures at end-2025. The ISA/unit trust figure includes £3.7bn in bespoke portfolios run by managers for wealthier clients.

The funds: who actually invests the money?

SJP's investment team mostly **doesn't pick shares itself**. It **chooses outside expert fund managers**, gives each one part of the money to run, and checks their work. A useful picture is a **football manager picking players** rather than playing.

- **Polaris** is SJP's biggest fund range, at about **£94bn**. It comes in four risk levels, from cautious to adventurous.
- The money is spread around the world: about 38% in US and Canadian shares, 17% in bonds (loans to governments and companies), and the rest in Europe, Asia, the UK and cash.

Services: what the adviser helps with

Retirement
When can I stop work? How do I draw income?

Investing
Using ISA and pension allowances; choosing the right risk.

Inheritance
Passing money on, trusts, inheritance tax.

Protection
Life cover, illness cover, income protection.

Business owners
Taking money out of a company; planning a sale.

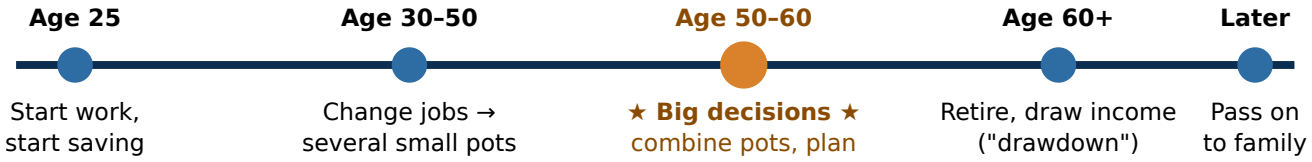
Mortgages and wills
Arranged through separate partner firms, not SJP itself.

PAGE 7 · THE BIG ONE

Why pensions matter so much

Pensions are **55% of SJP's money** and **63% of its new money** (2025). If you remember one product, remember pensions.

A pension over a lifetime



The orange point is where most people look for an adviser, which is why SJP's clients skew 45–70+.

Four reasons pensions are so important to SJP

1. Retirement got complicated

Since 2015, retirees can keep their pension invested and draw from it ("drawdown") instead of buying a fixed income for life. That means ongoing decisions, so people want advice.

2. People have lots of small pots

Combining old workplace pensions into one is a common, valuable piece of advice.

3. Tax

Pensions get tax relief. **From April 2027, unused pensions will count for inheritance tax**. That's a big change, and it creates more need for advice.

4. Money stays for decades

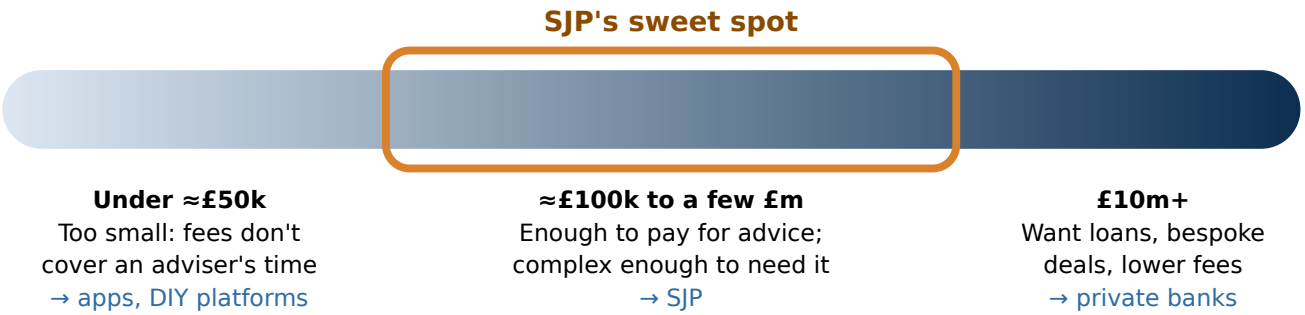
Only ≈4% of pension money leaves SJP each year, against ≈7% for ISAs and unit trusts. Long-lasting money means long-lasting fees.

SOMETHING YOU CAN SAY

"Pensions are over half of SJP's money, and the 2027 inheritance tax change makes retirement planning even more complex. That's a tailwind for advice."

Who SJP's clients are, and why

SJP aims at the "**sweet spot**": people with enough money that advice pays for itself, but not so rich that they want a private bank.



Meet three typical clients (made-up examples)

Sarah, 58

Owns a small company. Wants to sell it in 5 years and retire. Needs help taking money out tax-efficiently and planning her pension.

David & Priya, 66

Recently retired doctors. Want a steady income from their pensions and to help their children buy homes.

Tom, 45

Senior manager at a big firm. Has four old pensions and an ISA. Wants one clear plan and someone to call.

Why these clients make sense for SJP (the maths)

Client with £20k

0.8% = £160 a year

Client with £226k (average)

0.8% ≈ £1,800 a year

Average adviser (≈£49m)

≈£390k a year in fees

Advice takes hours of an expert's time. Only clients with a decent amount of money generate enough in fees to pay for it. That's why SJP focuses on the comfortably-off, and why its typical client is a **pre-retiree, retiree, professional or business owner** who arrives through a **referral** from a friend, an accountant or a solicitor.

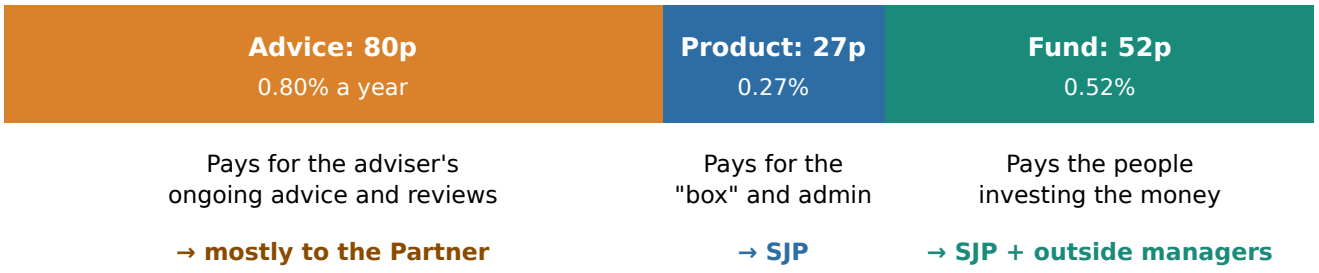
PAGE 9 · FEES

What a client pays

Since **26 August 2025**, SJP's fees are split into clear parts. There's a one-off fee at the start, then three yearly fees.

Every £100 invested: the yearly cost

Yearly cost on £100 (ISA in a typical Polaris fund) = £1.59



Pays for the adviser's ongoing advice and reviews	Pays for the "box" and admin	Pays the people investing the money
→ mostly to the Partner	→ SJP	→ SJP + outside managers

For a pension, the product fee is 0.35%, so the total is ≈1.67%. Fund fees vary by fund; 0.52% is SJP's own example.

Plus a one-off fee at the start (the "initial advice charge")

Part of the money invested	Fee
First £250,000	3%
Next £250,000	2%
Anything above £500,000	1%
Maximum £30,000. This mostly goes to the Partner.	

Worked example: £500,000 into an ISA

£12,500
one-off, at the start
(3% × £250k + 2% × £250k)

£7,950
every year after
(1.59% × £500k)

WHAT CHANGED IN 2025

Before August 2025, SJP's fees were bundled together and harder to see. Clients who left within six years could pay an **exit fee of up to 6%**. The new system shows each fee separately and has **no exit fee on new money**. Page 14 explains why it changed.

How SJP makes its profit

SJP's profit is basically: **money looked after × the small slice SJP keeps − costs**.

Money looked after (£240bn) × **SJP's slice (≈0.45% a year)** − **Costs** = **Profit**

Where SJP's 2025 income came from



- **£725m** from yearly charges. The engine, and it repeats every year.
- **£100m** from new-business charges. Under the new fees this drops to ≈£0 from 2026.
- **£69m** interest on SJP's own cash.

After paying staff, offices, technology and other costs, SJP made **£462m profit** in 2025.

> **THE BIGGEST MONEY-MAKER**
> **Yearly percentage charges on client money**, and pensions most of all, because they're the biggest pile and stay the longest. It works like a subscription: once money is in, it pays SJP every year it stays.

The four levers that move profit

1. Stock markets ↑↓

If markets rise 10%, the money looked after rises, and so do the fees. In 2025, market growth added £23.6bn, nearly four times the £6.2bn of new money.

2. Net new money

Money coming in minus money leaving. Winning clients *and* keeping them.

3. The slice SJP keeps

It fell when fees were simplified in 2025, and is expected to creep back up as older money moves onto the new fees.

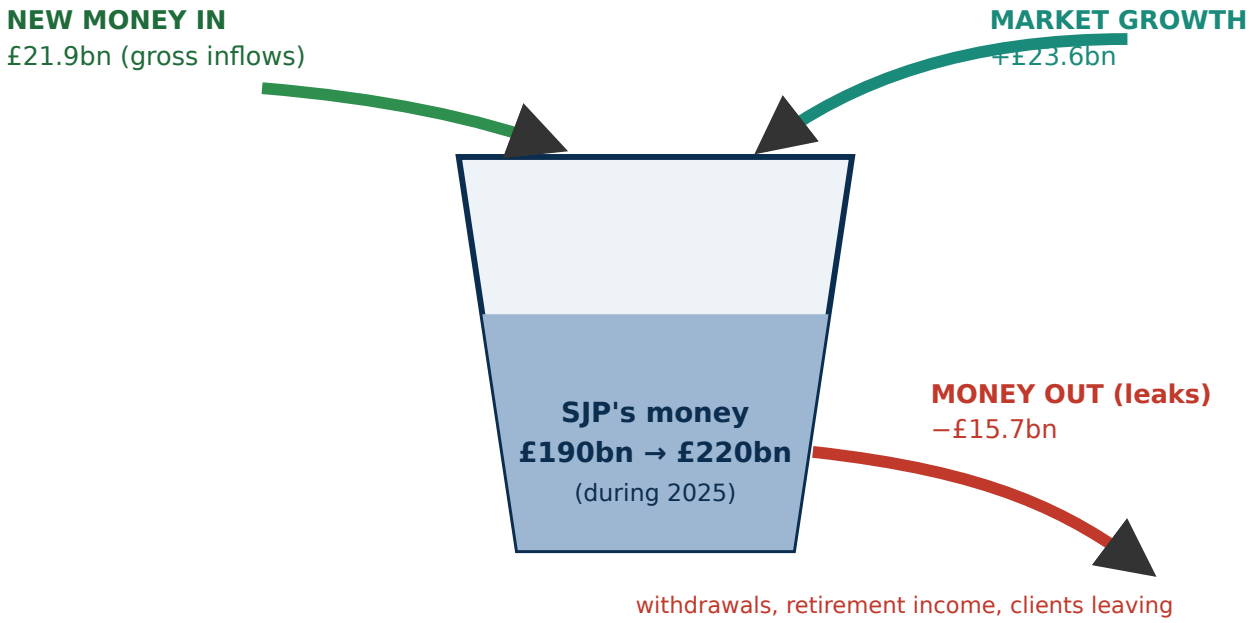
4. Costs

SJP is cutting ≈£100m of yearly costs by 2027.

PAGE 11 · THE KEY INSIGHT

The leaky bucket: money in and money out

This page is the smartest point you can make in an interview, so it's worth understanding well.



2025	Amount	What it means
Gross inflows	**£21.9bn**	New money invested. A record.
Money out	**−£15.7bn**	About 5% of the bucket leaks out each year (95% "retention")
Net inflows	**£6.2bn**	What's left after the leak, only ≈3% growth from new money
Market growth	**+£23.6bn**	Investments rising in value

WHY IT MATTERS

SJP is great at bringing money in. But with ≈5% leaking out every year, it needs **≈£11bn+ a year of new money just to stand still**. In 2026 net inflows slowed: £2.7bn in the first half, then just £0.57bn in July–September. Rivals like Quilter and AJ Bell are growing at about 9% a year from new money, against SJP's ≈2.5%.

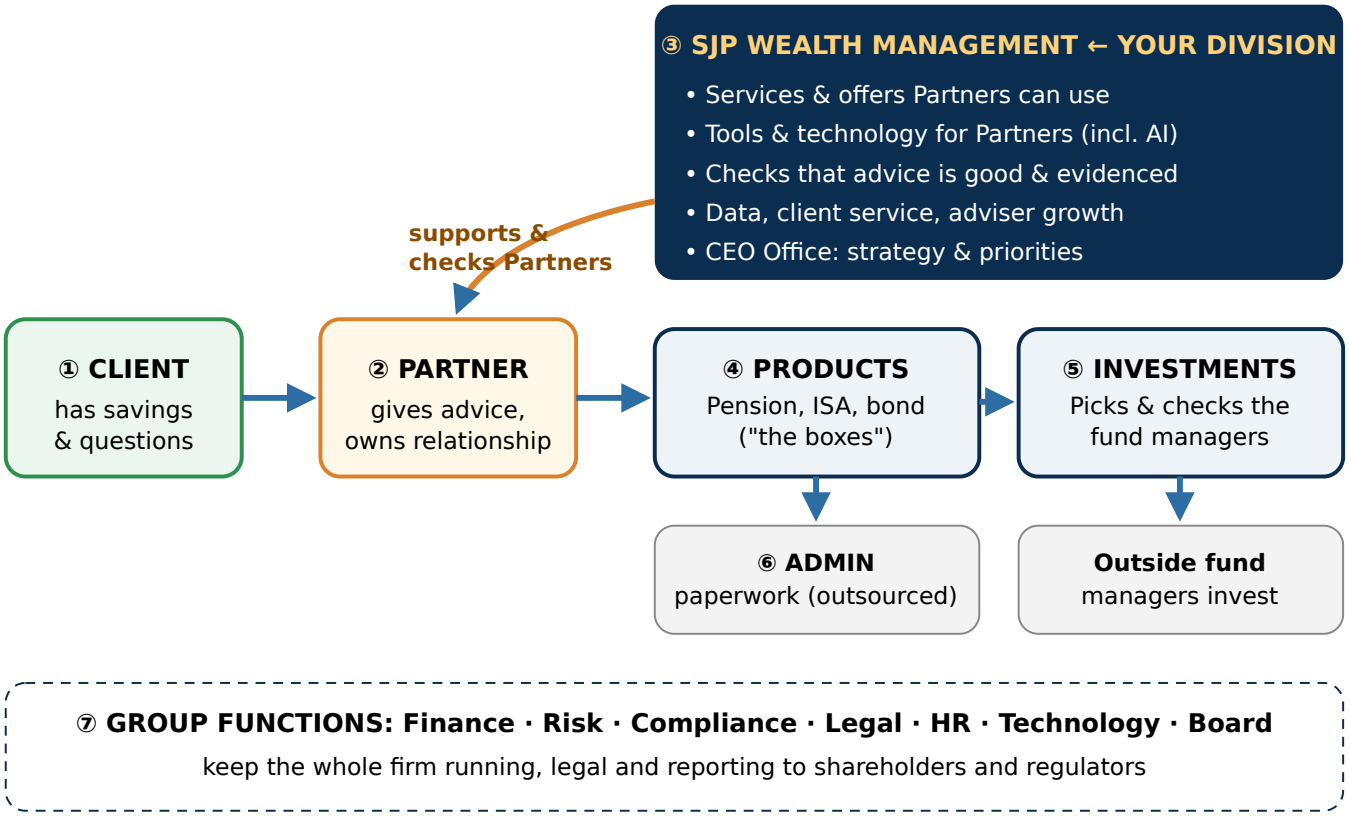
Some leaking is natural: older clients take income in retirement, which is what the money was for. But it's the number analysts watch most closely.

SOMETHING YOU CAN SAY

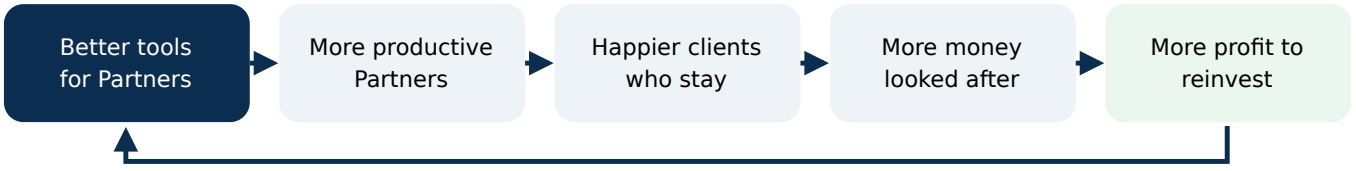
"SJP's gross inflows are strong, but with about 95% retention it needs over £11bn a year just to stand still. So the number I'd watch is **net** inflows."

How all the parts work together

SJP is made of several teams that each do one job. Here's how they connect.



The cycle that keeps it growing



The Wealth Management division (where you'd work) sits at the **start** of this cycle.

One client's journey, step by step

Let's follow **Sarah, 58, business owner**, through SJP, and see which part of the firm is involved at each step.

1. **Referral**
   Sarah's accountant recommends an SJP Partner. [Partner]

2. **Fact-find**
   The Partner learns everything: income, pensions, goals, how much risk she can take. [Partner, using SJP's tools and templates from Wealth Management]

3. **Plan & recommendation**
   A cashflow plan shows she can retire at 63. The Partner recommends combining 3 pensions into an SJP pension, yearly ISA top-ups, and an inheritance plan. Written up in a "suitability report". [Partner; advice checked by Wealth Management]

4. **Money moves in**
   Pensions transferred into an SJP pension (product). Paperwork done by the outsourced administrator. [Products + Admin]

5. **Money invested**
   Invested in Polaris, run by outside fund managers that SJP chose. [Investments]

6. **Every year: review & fees**
   The Partner reviews the plan each year. Sarah pays ≈1.6–1.7% a year. The review must be recorded as proof it happened. [Partner + Wealth Management + Finance]

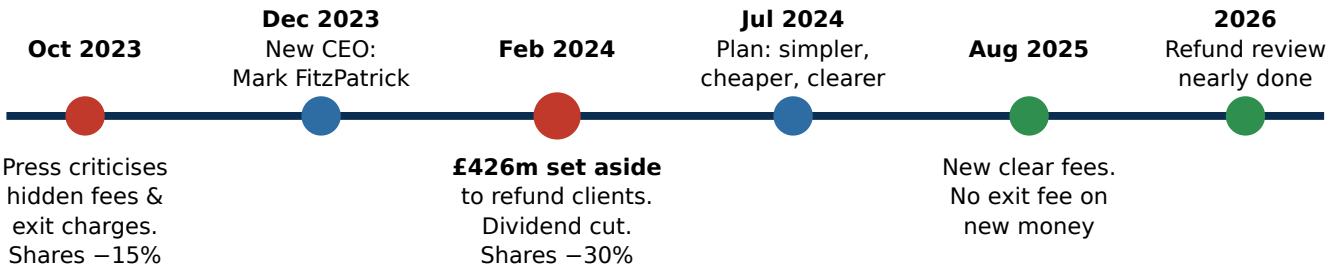
7. **She stays, adds more, and introduces her children → SJP grows.**

NOTICE

Wealth Management (your division) shows up at steps 2, 3 and 6, behind the scenes, making the Partner's job easier and making sure the advice is good.

What went wrong, and how it was fixed

You **must** know this story. Interviewers expect you to know it, and to talk about it calmly and fairly.



Red = problem · Blue = response · Green = fix

Problem 1: the exit fee

Clients who moved their money out within 6 years paid up to **6%**. Critics said this **trapped** unhappy clients and hid the real cost. **Fixed:** scrapped for new money from Aug 2025. Older money still carries it until about 2031.

Problem 2: reviews not delivered

Clients paid a yearly fee for an annual review, but some couldn't be shown to have had one. In Feb 2024 SJP set aside **£426m** to refund them (covering fees back to 2018). **Now:** it needed less than expected; £110m was left in mid-2026 and the review should finish in 2026.

WHY IT CAME TO A HEAD: "CONSUMER DUTY"

New FCA rules from July 2023 changed the standard from *"did you tell the client?"* to *"is the client getting **fair value**, and can you **prove** it?"*. Bundled fees and unproven reviews didn't pass that test. Other firms (Quilter, Rathbones) have had similar ongoing-advice issues.

DON'T SAY

"The FCA fined SJP £426m." That's wrong. The £426m was SJP's **own** refund budget, not a fine.

SOMETHING YOU CAN SAY

"Consumer Duty raised the bar from disclosure to proving fair value. SJP responded by simplifying its fees, removing exit charges and refunding clients, and that review is nearly complete."

PAGE 15 · TODAY

What's happening now (late 2026)

SJP's strategy in two phases

"STRENGTHEN" (2024–2026)
Fix the basics: new fees, refunds, cut costs

→

"AMPLIFY" (2027 onwards)
Grow faster. ← You'd join in Sept 2027

The last 12 months in brief

When	What happened	Good or bad for SJP?
Feb 2026	Record 2025 results. SJP promises to return 70% of profit to shareholders	**Good**
Feb 2026	Shares fall sharply on fears that AI tools could replace advisers	**Worry**
Apr 2026	New FCA "targeted support" rules let firms give simpler, cheaper help to people who can't afford advice	**Mixed**
Jun 2026	NatWest bank buys the wealth manager Evelyn Partners: a new, bank-backed rival	**Competition**
Jul 2026	Record £240.8bn of money looked after; refund budget down to £110m; profit down as expected after the fee change	**Mostly good**
Oct 2026	Net new money slows to £0.57bn for July–September; shares dip	**Worry**
Apr 2027	Unused pensions start to count for inheritance tax	**More need for advice**

Who runs SJP

Mark FitzPatrick
Group Chief Executive (since Dec 2023)

James Rainbow
CEO of SJP Wealth Management, **your division** (joined 2025 from Schroders, per press reports)

Caroline Waddington
Chief Financial Officer

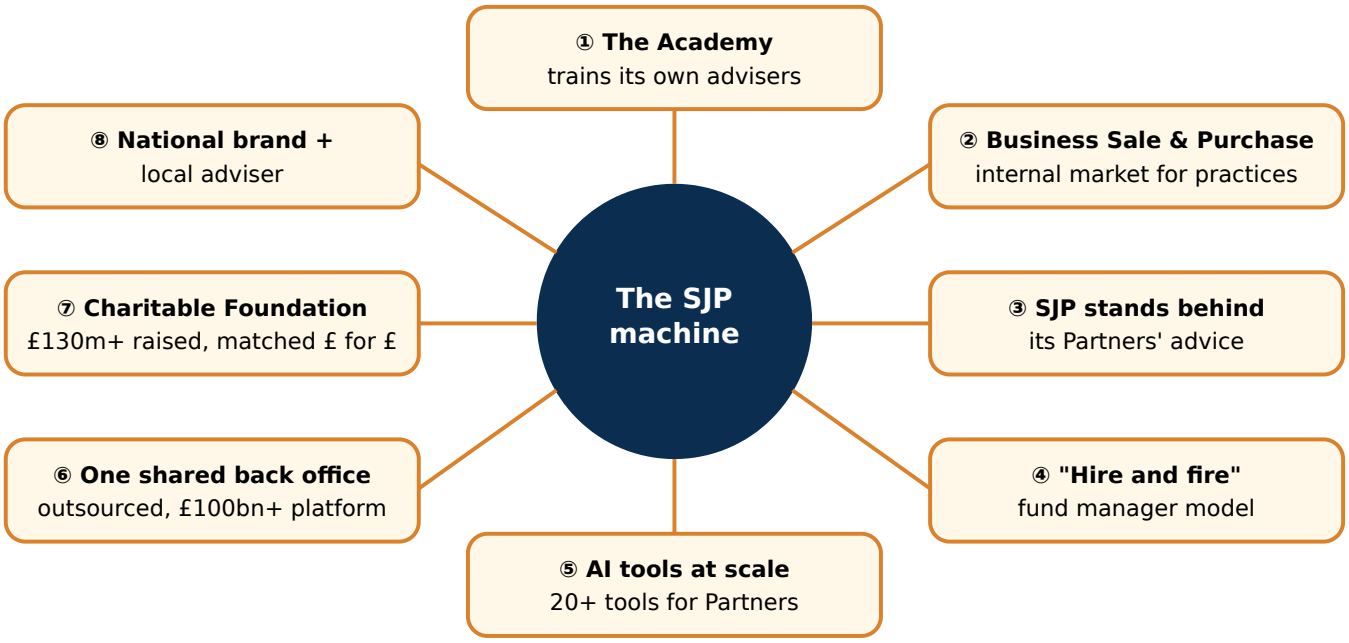
Paul Manduca
Chair of the Board

Check the share price and any news on SJP's website the week before your interview.

WHAT MAKES SJP DIFFERENT · 1 of 4

What makes SJP different (beyond "we give good advice")

Every wealth firm says it has great advice and great people. These are the **specific systems** SJP has built that rivals mostly don't have, or don't have at this scale.



THE BIG IDEA THAT TIES THEM TOGETHER

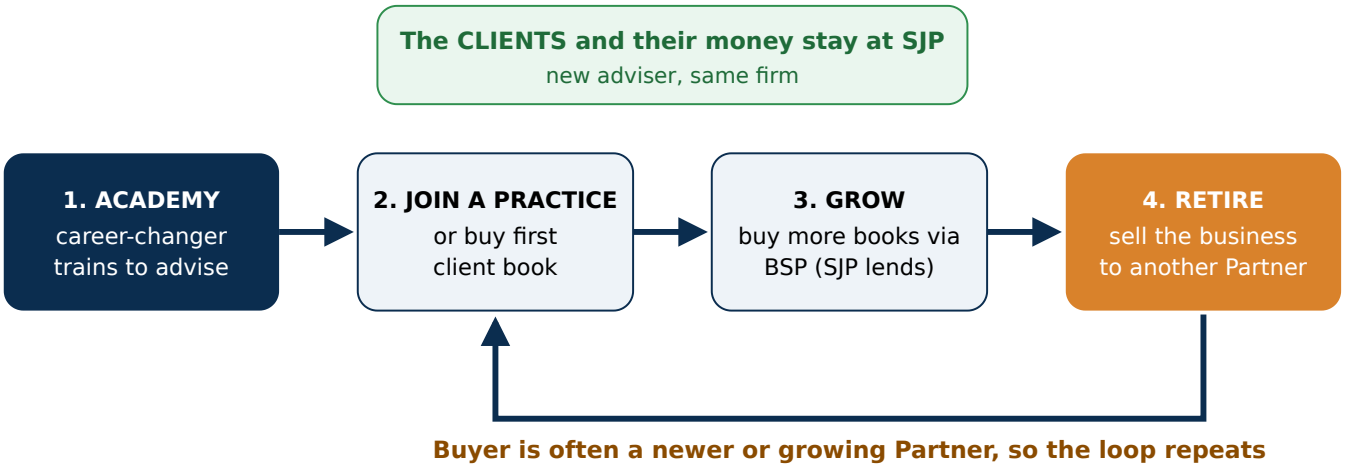
Most advice firms are small and independent: one firm, a few advisers, and no plan for when the founder retires. SJP has built a **complete life-cycle system for advisers**. It **creates** them (Academy), **equips** them (tools, products, brand), **stands behind** them (guarantees their advice), and lets them **buy and sell** client books internally (BSP). So clients and their money stay inside SJP even when individual advisers come and go. That's a big reason retention stays around 95%.

Sources: mainly SJP's Half Year 2026 results presentation (July 2026) plus trade press (Money Marketing, Professional Adviser). Some figures are SJP's own claims; these are marked "SJP says".

WHAT MAKES SJP DIFFERENT · 2 of 4

The adviser life-cycle: the Academy and BSP

This is probably SJP's most distinctive piece of structure, and it's exactly the area your division supports.



① The SJP Academy (since 2012)

• Trains people, often career-changers, to become qualified advisers.
• **200** advisers graduated in Oct 2026; 175 in 2025.
• SJP says it trains **around half of all new advisers** entering the UK profession.
• 89%+ are still at SJP three years later.
Why it matters: the UK has an ageing adviser population. SJP *manufactures* its own replacements instead of competing for scarce experienced advisers.

② Business Sale & Purchase (BSP), since 1992

• An **internal marketplace** where Partners buy and sell client businesses.
• **5,000th** deal completed in March 2026.
• About **250–300 deals a year**, worth about **£200m** a year.
• H1 2026: nearly **200 advisers bought**, including SJP's **largest ever** BSP deal.
• SJP **lends Partners the money** to buy.
Why it matters: it gives a Partner's business a **sale value**, which makes them want to stay. And when they retire, clients pass to another SJP adviser instead of leaving.

WHY RIVALS FIND THIS HARD TO COPY

An independent adviser who retires usually sells to an outside buyer, often a private-equity-backed "consolidator", and clients may move platform or leave. At SJP the buyer is inside the system and SJP finances the deal. It's a **succession machine**, and it took 30+ years and a huge adviser base to build. The CFO called BSP "a critical part of what we offer our advisers… from recruitment to retirement".

WHAT MAKES SJP DIFFERENT · 3 of 4

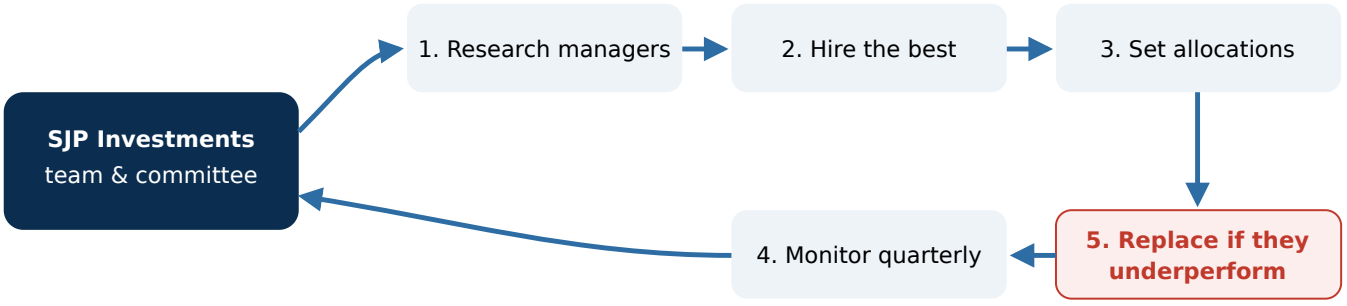
Investment model, advice guarantee, back office

③ SJP stands behind its Partners' advice

In SJP's own words (H1 2026): *"We guarantee their advice and provide the technical insights to help them understand and adapt their advice for changes in the tax, pension, regulatory and political landscape."*

Because SJP is the regulated "principal", **clients complain to SJP, and SJP pays any redress**. The £426m refund provision is the proof that this is real. A small independent adviser has to carry that risk alone, and its insurance may not cover it. For clients, it means a FTSE 100 company backs the advice. For advisers, it's protection plus a central technical team on tax and pension changes. **Your division runs much of this.**

④ The "hire and fire" fund manager model



SJP mostly **doesn't pick shares itself**. It acts like a **football manager**: it picks outside expert fund managers, gives each a slice of the money, and replaces them if they underperform. Clients never have to move their money, because the fund keeps its SJP name while the managers inside it change.

Real example (2025): SJP switched its £1.9bn Global Smaller Companies fund from one manager to **seven**, hiring six new managers alongside the existing one. For its new cheaper **Polaris Multi-Index** range (2025), State Street built 14 index funds, while SJP's in-house team sets the overall mix.

⑥ One shared back office

SJP outsources its administration to the technology firm **SS&C**, and has done since 2002. All products run on SS&C's **Bluedoor** platform, which handles **£100bn+**. Partners don't have to choose or pay for their own platform, compliance systems or fund research, as an independent adviser would. They plug into SJP's.

Note: the Bluedoor details come from SS&C/trade press coverage, around 2019. Check that the current set-up hasn't changed.

WHAT MAKES SJP DIFFERENT · 4 of 4

AI at scale, culture, and what's coming

⑤ AI tools: SJP's answer to the "AI will replace advisers" fear

After the February 2026 share sell-off over AI fears, SJP set out its position: *"far from being a threat to our model, we see AI as an enabler of it."* It says it has **more than 20 AI tools** in use. The three it named:

Tool	What it does	Result SJP reports
Advice Assistant	Drafts advice paperwork (e.g. suitability reports). Built with SS&C and intellectAI	Saves **≈90 minutes per case**
ChatSJP	An internal chatbot answering policy and advice questions for Partner practices, 24/7	**≈2,500** monthly users; ≈15 minutes saved per question
SOFI	"Meeting intelligence": automates note-taking and meeting admin	Pilot firms grew new clients faster than a control group, especially small practices. Now rolling out to all Partners

Why scale matters here: one SJP investment in a tool reaches ≈5,000 advisers at once. A small independent firm can't build or buy that. SJP's three AI principles are "human-centric AI", "ecosystem-led innovation" (partnering with tech firms) and "data as a strategic asset".

⑦ Culture: the Charitable Foundation

SJP's Foundation has raised **£130m+** since 1992. SJP **matches every £1** raised, and over **70%** of Partners and employees give monthly (2024 report). It was £9.7m in 2024 including the matching. That's unusual for a financial firm, and it's a big part of how SJP builds a shared identity across thousands of self-employed advisers.

⑧ National brand + local adviser

SJP calls this "the best of both worlds": a personal local adviser backed by a FTSE 100 brand. SJP says its **net promoter score** (how likely clients are to recommend it) and **brand awareness** have each risen **14 percentage points** since end-2023. In a business built on referrals, that matters.

Recent and upcoming initiatives to know

New Partner pay (2026)

Simpler adviser pay that rewards **high-quality, whole-of-life advice**, not just bringing in money. Funded through cost savings.

Wider product shelf

Polaris Multi-Index (cheaper, index-based) and a cash/cash-ISA service through partner firm **Flagstone**.

Wealthier clients (Amplify)

SJP says it will build more support for clients with "complex and substantial" wealth from 2027.

HOW TO USE THIS IN YOUR INTERVIEW

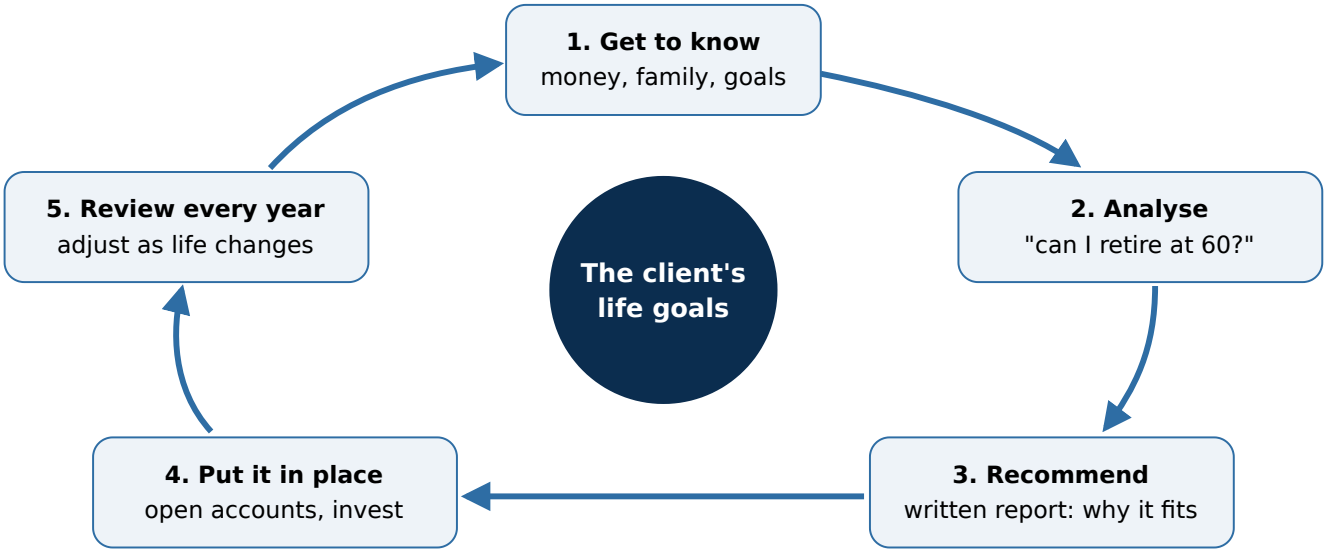
"What struck me is that SJP isn't just an advice firm. It's built a whole life-cycle for advisers: the Academy creates them, SJP backs their advice, and the Business Sale and Purchase market lets them build and sell businesses. So the clients stay inside SJP even when advisers retire. Now it's adding AI tools like Advice Assistant and SOFI across 5,000 advisers. That's scale a small firm can't match, and it's the kind of work the Wealth Management division drives."

PAGE 16 · THE INDUSTRY

What "wealth management" really means

Wealth management means **helping a person plan and look after their money across their whole life**: growing it, protecting it, drawing on it in retirement, and passing it on.

The advice cycle: what an adviser actually does



Wealth management vs asset management (people mix these up)

Wealth management

Serves **people**. Asks "what should *this person* do with their money?" Long relationships. **Example: SJP.**

Asset management

Makes **funds**. Asks "how do we make this fund perform?" Sells to millions; never meets most investors. **Example: BlackRock.**

SJP is mainly a **wealth manager**. It has an investment arm, but uses outside asset managers to run most of the money.

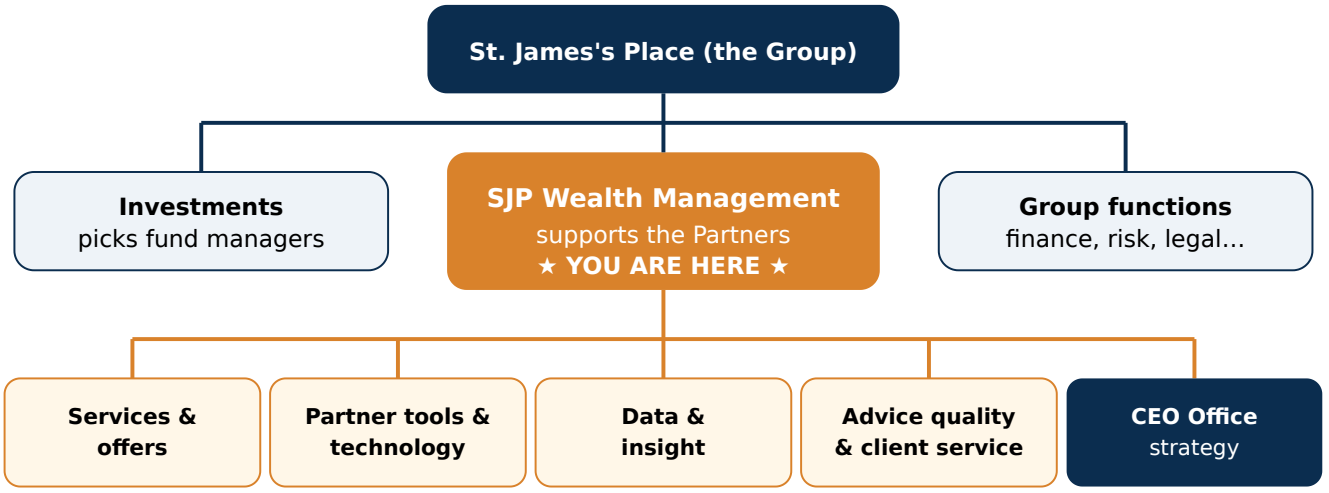
The rules of the game, in one line each

FCA	The regulator; sets the rules on treating customers fairly
Level 4 qualification	The exam level you need to give investment advice in the UK (you'll study for this)
Consumer Duty	Firms must deliver good outcomes and fair value, and prove it
Suitability	Advice must fit that specific client
Financial Ombudsman	Free service that settles customer complaints against firms
Restricted vs independent	Restricted (like SJP) recommends a limited range; independent can recommend anything on the market

PAGE 17 · YOUR JOB

Your job: where you'd sit

You'd work in **head office**, in the team that **supports the ≈5,000 Partners**. You won't be advising clients yourself. Your "customers" are mainly the **Partners**, and through them the clients.



Likely teams, based on the job description. SJP hasn't published the exact list, so ask about it in your interview.

The job description confirms you'll do projects in the Wealth Management "Chief Executive Office".

The facts from the job description

2 years
rotating through different teams

Permanent
job from day one; you stay in the division afterwards

Level 4
Diploma in Regulated Financial Planning, paid for and supported

London
Lombard Street office

3+ days
a week in the office (hybrid)

Sept 2027
start date

PAGE 18 · YOUR JOB

Your job: what you'd actually do

Your two years at a glance (illustrative)

Rotation 1	Rotation 2	Rotation 3	Rotation 4
e.g. Data & insight	e.g. Partner tools	e.g. Services/offers	e.g. CEO Office

Running alongside: studying for the Level 4 Diploma in Regulated Financial Planning

The number and order of rotations are a guess; ask SJP how it works.

What the job description says, and what it means in real life

Job description says…	…in real life (example task)
"Analyse data and produce insights"	Use Excel to find which types of client took the most money out this year, and explain why in a short summary
"Prepare reports and presentations for senior leaders"	Build 5 clear slides on how a new adviser tool is going, with a recommendation on page 1
"Projects that enhance the adviser and client experience"	Collect feedback from Partners on an AI note-taking tool and measure how much time it saves
"Support strategic initiatives"	Help plan how SJP supports clients when pensions enter inheritance tax in April 2027
"Build relationships across the business"	Work with Partners, compliance, investment and tech teams on one project
"Participate in projects within the CEO Office"	Track progress on the "Amplify" growth plan and prepare updates for the leadership team

The Level 4 Diploma, simply

This is the qualification UK advisers **must** have to give investment advice. It usually covers six topics:

- 📘 Rules & ethics of financial services
- 📘 Investments & risk
- 📘 Personal tax
- 📘 Pensions & retirement
- 📘 Protection (insurance)
- 📘 Putting it all into a financial plan

Based on the standard CII Diploma (DipPFS). The job description doesn't name the provider, so ask which route SJP uses.

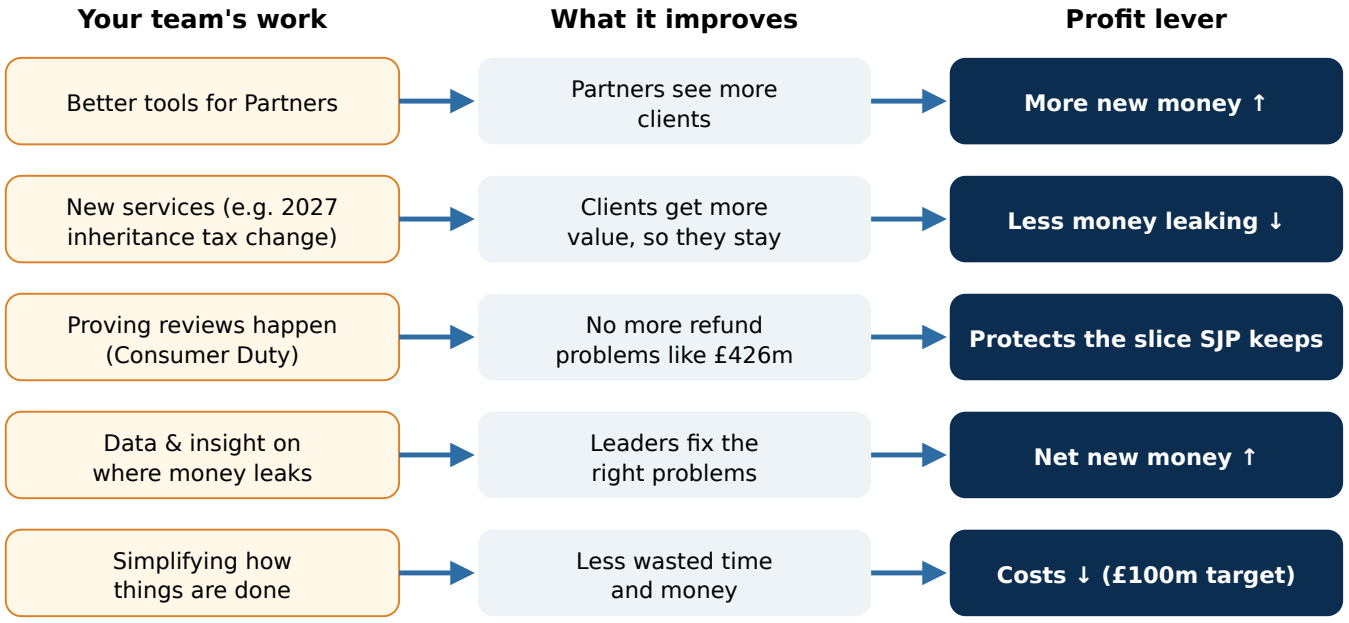
WHY IT'S VALUABLE

You'll understand exactly what Partners do, which makes your head-office work much better. Present it as "understanding the advice process from the inside", **not** as a way to become an adviser.

PAGE 19 · THE BIG PICTURE

How your work connects to profit

Remember the four profit levers from page 10? Head-office work mostly pushes on them through the Partners and clients.



YOUR "WHY THIS ROLE" LINE

"SJP's profit comes from the money its Partners look after. The Wealth Management team is where SJP makes its Partners more productive and its advice provably good. That brings more money in, keeps it there, and protects the margin. That's the part of the business I want to work in."

Your 60-second summary

If you remember nothing else, learn this. It covers everything an interviewer expects you to know.

"St. James's Place is the UK's largest financial advice business. It looks after about **£240 billion** for over **a million clients** through around **5,000 self-employed advisers called Partners**. It's **vertically integrated**: it provides the advice and also owns the pensions, ISAs and funds clients invest in. It earns mainly through **yearly percentage fees**, and **pensions** are the biggest part.

Its clients are mostly comfortably-off people approaching or in retirement, professionals and business owners, who need help with complex decisions like retirement income and inheritance.

It's been through a tough period. Its fees were criticised as unclear, and in 2024 it set aside **£426m** to refund clients for reviews it couldn't prove had happened. Under the FCA's **Consumer Duty** it has since **simplified its fees, removed exit charges** and nearly finished the refunds.

Now it's moving into its **"Amplify"** growth phase. The key challenge is turning strong new money into stronger **net** growth. The Wealth Management division helps do that by making Partners more productive and advice provably good."

✓ Five things to say

1. "SJP's real strength is its ≈5,000 Partners and ≈95% client retention."
2. "The 2025 fee change made pricing clear, and new money now earns fees from day one."
3. "Consumer Duty moved the bar from telling clients to proving fair value."
4. "Gross inflows are strong; **net** inflows are the number to watch."
5. "Pensions entering inheritance tax in 2027 increases the need for advice."

✗ Five things to avoid

1. "SJP is a private bank for the super-rich." It isn't.
2. "The FCA fined SJP £426m." It didn't. That was SJP's own refund budget.
3. "SJP's advisers are independent." They're **restricted**.
4. "I want to become an adviser." This is a head-office role.
5. Exact share prices or disputed numbers. Use rounded figures instead.

TALKING ABOUT THE SCANDAL

Don't avoid it and don't dwell on it. Use the pattern **what happened → what SJP changed → what's still being finished**, in about 20 seconds, then move on.

Glossary: every term in plain English

Term	Meaning
Adviser / Partner	A qualified person who recommends what to do with your money. SJP's are self-employed "Partners".
Amplify / Strengthen	SJP's strategy phases: fixing the basics (2024–26), then growing (2027+).
Bond (in a portfolio)	A loan to a government or company that pays interest. Different from an "investment bond" wrapper.
Cashflow modelling	A year-by-year projection of someone's money to test plans like "can I retire at 60?".
Consumer Duty	FCA rules (2023) requiring good outcomes and fair value for customers, with proof.
Dividend / buyback	Ways a company returns profit to its shareholders: cash payments, or buying back its own shares.
Drawdown	Keeping a pension invested in retirement and taking income from it.
Exit fee (early withdrawal charge)	SJP's old charge of up to 6% for leaving within 6 years. Scrapped for new money in Aug 2025.
FCA	Financial Conduct Authority, the UK regulator.
Fund	A pot of pooled money invested by a professional manager.
FUM	Funds Under Management: all the client money a firm looks after.
Gross / net inflows	New money in / new money in minus money out.
Inheritance tax (IHT)	Tax on what you leave when you die. Unused pensions will count from April 2027.
ISA	A wrapper where up to £20k a year grows tax-free.
Level 4 Diploma	The qualification needed to give investment advice in the UK.
Pension	A tax-advantaged wrapper for retirement savings.
Polaris	SJP's biggest fund range (≈£94bn), with four risk levels.
Private bank	A bank for very wealthy clients (e.g. Coutts).
Provision	Money a company sets aside in its accounts for an expected future cost (e.g. SJP's £426m for refunds).
Restricted vs independent	Restricted advisers recommend a limited range of products (SJP); independent advisers can recommend anything.
Retention	The share of client money that stays each year (SJP ≈95%).
Suitability report	The written explanation of why advice suits a particular client.
Targeted support	New FCA category (April 2026): simpler, cheaper help that falls short of full advice.
Vertical integration	One company owning several stages of what the customer buys (for SJP: advice, product and funds).

Wealth management	Helping people plan and look after their money over their whole life.
Wrapper	The tax "box" investments sit in: pension, ISA, investment bond, unit trust.

Sources: SJP Full Year Results 2025 and Half Year 2026 reports, SJP charges announcement (2025), FCA publications, and press coverage (Investment Week, Money Marketing, Sharecast, City AM). See the companion packs for detailed source links. Prepared 6 November 2026.